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A recent news piece about China's export restriction that Reuters reported forced the industry to reckon the cost of Lithium Ion batteries. This time, China has drawn out cards to stop feeding the world with natural resources that it used to. There are two ways to put out a fire, one is to cut heat and oxygen while the other is to stop the fuel. As energy industries are growing like forest fires in developing countries, China is back again in its form to hinder growth. It started to implement rules and laws to do its best to put out this fire. Today, we will learn about how this strategy to hinder the graphite supply impacts the world.

The news I was talking about in the initial part of this article is that China decided to restrict its graphite exports. The official statement for this decision was similar to what has been given to other such policies being "to protect national security and ensure the supply of graphite for domestic industries".

Relation Between Graphite and China

Graphite is the key material for multiple industries including lithium-ion batteries. China is the world's largest producer as well as consumer of graphite. **It produces about 79 percent of the world's natural graphite and consumes about 70 percent. Only Nine percent of its graphite production holds the ability to coup the market.**

As the world is looking for fossil fuel substitutes for transportation and electricity has come up as the closest solution, another big thing is making batteries for electric vehicles. This mobility shift has given rise to a number of countries making electric cars but China has created hardship for all

the aspiring countries. This step not only preserves the monopoly of China on the global front but also helps eliminate competitors.